

In Brief



Amplifying and consolidating women's leadership in local governance, peace, and security processes in Bungoma and Vihiga Counties.

This is the final report brief for the phase II project “*Amplifying and consolidating women's leadership in local governance, peace, and security processes in Bungoma and Vihiga Counties*,” implemented by **UN Women** in partnership with the Office of the **High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR)**, **Echo Network Africa Foundation (ENAF)**, and the **National Council of Churches of Kenya (NCCK)** through the generous support from the **Government of Ireland**.

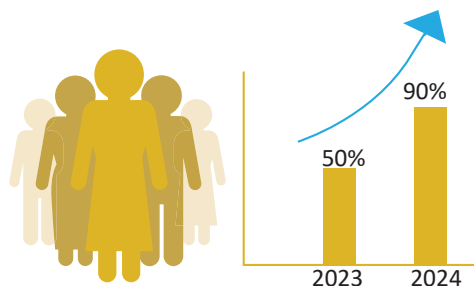
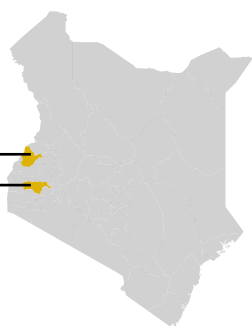
The report covers the **2024** implementation period, where **UN Women** and its partners implemented interventions aimed at advancing the role of women in peace, security, and governance processes.

In **2024**, women in **Bungoma** and **Vihiga** Counties moved from the margins of public life to actively shaping local governance, peace, and security processes. More women are now speaking up, influencing policy, and holding county governments accountable. This shift was most visible in the peace and leadership spaces, where women transitioned from passive participants to credible decision-makers.

In the peace and security sector, **90 percent** of targeted women reported increased capacity and agency—up from **50 percent** in 2023.

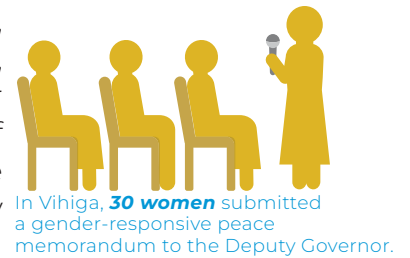
Amplifying and consolidating women's leadership in local governance, peace, and security processes project

Bungoma
Vihiga

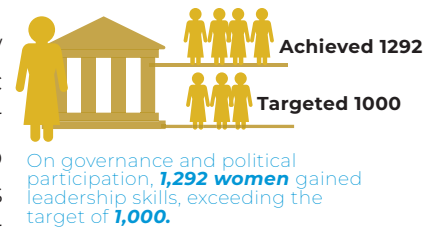


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Women peace actors played leading roles in conflict resolution, budget advocacy, and formal peace structures. In Mt. Elgon, women led a review of the Mabanga Peace Accord with their recommendations formally endorsed by the Supreme Council of Elders. In **Vihiga, 30 women** submitted a gender-responsive peace memorandum to the Deputy Governor, while others convened Early Warning Early Response forums across four sub-counties.



On governance and political participation, **1,292 women** gained leadership skills, exceeding the target of **1,000**. Women are now more confident engaging with county structures, influencing public dialogue, and preparing to contest in the **2027 elections**. Their priorities—captured in county-level Women's Manifestos—are no longer just advocacy tools but key priorities. Four of these priorities were translated into formal county policies, including on gender mainstreaming, disability inclusion, and child protection.



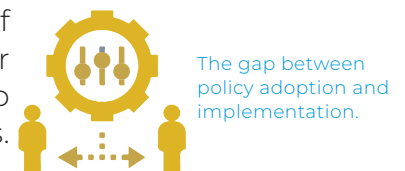
The political behavior of county governments also shifted for instance, in the two counties, they adopted seven gender-responsive commitments signaling increased institutional accountability to women's voices. County Gender Sector Working Groups operationalized dedicated Women's Leadership Pillars, creating permanent spaces to address structural barriers to women's representation.



Lessons learned include the persistence of cultural resistance to women's leadership, the gap between policy adoption and implementation, and the power of peer-led learning in building women's agency.



Next steps will focus on supporting implementation of enacted policies, scaling use of Women's Manifestos for accountability, operationalizing the Women's Leadership Academy, and introducing youth-focused components.



A Rapid Gender Analysis will inform engagement strategies ahead of the **2027 elections**, ensuring young and grassroots women are better positioned for political participation.



UN Women exist to advance Women's right, gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls. As the lead UN entity on gender equality, we shift laws institutions social behaviours and services to close the gender gap and build an equal world for all women and girls . We keep the rights of women and girls at the centre of global progress- always everywhere. Because gender equality is not just what we do, it is who we are.

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